Student ID #: _____

PSYC 105 Midterm Cheat Sheet (Front)

30 MC (1 each) + 3 of 4 SA (5 each) = 45 marks, 80 min. Fill Scantron bubbles completely.

CH 8: LANGUAGE, STRUCTURAL FEATURES

- **Phoneme** = smallest unit of **sound**. chairs = /ch/ /ai/ /r/ /s/ (6 letters, 4 sounds). cats = /k/ /a/ /t/ /s/. unlocked = /u/ /n/ /l/ /o/ /k/ /t/ (ck = 1 sound, -ed sounds like /t/).
- **Morpheme** = smallest unit of **meaning** (word, prefix, suffix). chairs = (chair)(s) = 2. cats = (cat)(s). unlocked = (un)(lock)(ed) = 3.
- **Syntax** = rules for ordering words into sentences. "Dog bites man" vs "Man bites dog" (same words, different meaning).
- **Extralinguistic information** = meaning from outside the words: tone of voice, facial expression, gestures, context (e.g., sarcastic "Great job").

CH 8: PROPERTIES OF LANGUAGE

- **Generative**: finite sounds/words combine into unlimited new sentences others understand.
- **Arbitrary / symbolic**: words don't resemble what they mean ("cat" doesn't look/sound like a cat); link is a shared convention.
- **Specialized brain areas**: usually left hemisphere; Broca's area (speech production), Wernicke's area (comprehension).
- **Developmental stages**: language is learned in a predictable sequence. Deaf babies show **manual babbling** (repetitive hand shapes, ~9 months), like vocal babbling.

CH 8: SIGN LANGUAGE (GESTURE ACTIVITY)

- Guessing made-up gestures was hard because it's hard to invent signs for words, and **we don't already know the correct ASL sign**.
- **True sign languages (ASL) are real languages**: same **structural features** as spoken language; signs are generally **arbitrary and symbolic** (not pantomime); generative; same developmental stages (manual babbling).

CH 8: WAIS-IV (WECHSLER ADULT INTELLIGENCE SCALE)

4 index scores make up overall IQ:

- **Verbal Comprehension**: **Similarities** (how are 2 things alike), **Vocabulary** (define words), **Information** (general knowledge).
- **Perceptual Reasoning**: **Block Design** (copy pattern with coloured blocks), **Matrix Reasoning** (pick piece that completes a pattern), **Visual Puzzles** (pick pieces that build a shape).
- **Working Memory**: **Digit Span** (repeat number strings), **Arithmetic** (mental math).
- **Processing Speed**: **Symbol Search** (find target symbols fast), **Coding** (copy symbols matched to numbers, timed).

Memory: V, P, W, S. Verbal + Perceptual have 3 subtests; WM + Speed have 2.

CH 8: CLASS "IQ TEST" ACTIVITY

- Q1 letters (A-P) = working memory. Q2 symbol-number key = processing speed. Q3 legs of Deacon, Pickerel, Manx, Weimaraner, Chesterfield = verbal/vocabulary, **BIASED: not common words**. Q4 = arithmetic/working memory. Q5 cross out shapes by rules = perceptual/working memory. Q6 number series = working memory. Q7 "leg flies one have only" = verbal/syntax, **BIASED: ambiguity**. Q8 X O X X O X pattern = perceptual reasoning. Q9 count cubes = perceptual reasoning (ambiguous figures). Q10 overlapping shapes = working memory.
- Questions read only once + **time pressure**.
- **Sources of test bias**: unfamiliar vocabulary / cultural knowledge; ambiguous wording or figures; time pressure / test conditions. Test may measure background instead of ability.

CH 8: ARMY BETA IQ TEST (1917)

- Picture-based test for WWI U.S. Army recruits who couldn't read English. Test 6: find the **missing part** of drawings (bowling alley, tennis court, phonograph, playing card).
- Lesson: **non-verbal does not mean culture-free**; still culturally biased.

CH 8: WHAT SHOULD IQ TESTS MEASURE?

- Most modern IQ tests focus on **cognitive abilities**.
- Some researchers argue **other factors** should be included (e.g., creativity, practical problem solving, emotional skills).

SHORT ANSWER: CORRELATION TEMPLATE

Ex: more coffee = more anxiety.
Scatterplot: positive slope (dots rise left to right) = 1; label **X = coffee consumption**, **Y = anxiety** (1/2 each).

- **Causal**: coffee causes anxiety.
- **Reverse causal**: anxiety causes more coffee drinking.
- **Third variable** (name a **specific** one): lack of sleep causes both more coffee and more anxiety.

Negative correlation = dots fall left to right.
No correlation = no pattern.

SHORT ANSWER TIPS

- Answer every part; each definition / example / explanation usually = 1 mark.
- Give a definition AND an example when asked for both. Label all graph axes.
- Answer only 3 of the 4 questions.

PSYC 105 Midterm Cheat Sheet (Back)

CH 11: 3 WAYS TO DEFINE/MEASURE STRESS

1. Stress as a STIMULUS (stressors = things that stress us out)

- **Social Readjustment Rating Scale (SRRS)**: 43 major life events, each with points. Death of spouse 100, divorce 73, marital separation 65, jail term 63, death of close family member 63, personal injury/illness 53, marriage 50, fired at work 47, marital reconciliation 45, retirement 45.
- **Daily Hassles Scale**: everyday annoyances rated 0 / 5 / 10: missing the bus, job vs college conflicts, noisy library/housemate, preparing meals, too little time, too little money, laundry, getting up in the morning, my weight, no time to exercise, noisy neighbours.
- **Major issue**: measuring the events that happen doesn't tell us how stressed people **felt** about them.

2. Stress as a RESPONSE (how we react)

- 4 parts: **thoughts, feelings, behaviours** (e.g., procrastinating), **physical sensations**.
- Stress **mobilizes energy**: **fight or flight**.
- Measures (physiological): **heart rate, blood pressure, galvanic skin response** (sweat/skin conductance), **hormones (cortisol)** from blood or saliva.
- **Major issue**: physical changes could be caused by things **other than stress** (e.g., excitement); they don't show how the person is **interpreting** the sensations.

3. Stress as a TRANSACTION

- **Stimulus + Appraisal = Response** (event + "how well can I handle it?" = how stressed you feel).
- Stress = **too many demands, too few resources**. Ex: demands = many assignments; resources = very little time; result = STRESS.
- Measure: **Perceived Stress Scale (PSS)**: 10 items about feelings/thoughts in the **last month**, rated 0 never, 1 almost never, 2 sometimes, 3 fairly often, 4 very often. Ex: "how often have you felt unable to control the important things in your life?", "felt nervous and stressed?", "felt confident about handling personal problems?", "felt difficulties piling up so high you could not overcome them?"
- Fixes earlier problems: it includes the person's own **appraisal**.

CH 11: APPRAISAL (EX: CAR BREAKS DOWN)

- **EVENT** leads to **Primary appraisal**: Is this situation a **threat**? What are the **demands**? If no: carry on, no stress. If yes: secondary appraisal.
- **Secondary appraisal**: **How well** can I cope? What are my **resources**? Minimal resources = **STRESS**. Many resources = **less stress**.

CH 11: WAYS OF COPING

- **1. Problem-focused coping**: change the **SITUATION**. Ex: call a tow truck.
- **2. Emotion-focused coping**: change your **REACTION** to the situation. Ex: deep breathing, change your focus, **cognitive reappraisal** (think about it differently).
- **3. Proactive coping**: do things **in advance** to **PREVENT** future stressors. Ex: schedule regular car maintenance.
- Can't change the situation: emotion-focused helps right now. Want a different outcome: need problem-focused. Big/complex stressors: need **both**.

CH 11: CLASS SCENARIOS (ANSWER KEY)

#1 Surprise quiz (scheduled, not in calendar, not studied, worth 5%)

- **Daily hassle**. Group ratings 2, 5, 4, 3 (people appraise differently).
- Problem: quickly look over notes; lie to prof about being sick (changes situation, bad idea). Emotion: relax because it's not worth much. Proactive: prevent next time (calendar).
- Could be either, but you **can't change the quiz**, so **emotion-focused** helps most right now.

#2 Best friend's party vs work shift (need rent money)

- **Daily hassle**. Ratings 3, 1, 4, 3.
- Problem: find someone to cover; try to get the party moved. Emotion: realize your friend will understand.
- Could be either, but if you really want to go, **problem-focused** is necessary.

#3 New job in new city in 3 weeks (move, clothes, loose ends)

- **Major life event (or two!)**. Ratings 4, 5, 4, 3.
- Problem: make a list and prioritize; ask friends/family to help move; get enough sleep and good food. Emotion: focus on the great opportunity and how exciting it is.
- Need **both**: lots to do, and need to adjust thinking/emotions.

CH 11: INDIVIDUAL DIFFERENCES

- People **perceive different amounts of stress** for the same situation.
- Affects wellbeing: some feel better at exam time or feel **excited** rather than terrified by big life changes.
- Reduce stress: emotion-focused (think of the situation differently) + **proactive** (organized, prepared, so you're **ready** for more).
- **Downside of low stress**: stress helps us **focus** on important events/tasks; without it you might not **change or improve**.

CH 11: DIAPHRAGMATIC BREATHING

- Activates the **parasympathetic nervous system** via the **vagus nerve**. It is **emotion-focused** (changes your reaction).
- How: sit, both feet flat. One hand on chest, one on belly below ribs (diaphragm). **Inhale for 3**: belly extends, chest and shoulders still. **Exhale for 5**: slow steady stream, push all air out. Focus on breathing, not stressful thoughts.

QUICK MC TRAPS

- Sounds = phoneme; meaning = morpheme; word order = syntax; tone/face/context = extralinguistic.
- Digit Span/Arithmetic = Working Memory (not Processing Speed). Coding/Symbol Search = Processing Speed.
- SRRS + Daily Hassles = stimulus. Heart rate/BP/GSR/cortisol = response. PSS = transaction.
- "Is it a threat?" = primary. "Can I cope?" = secondary.
- Tow truck = problem. Reappraisal/breathing = emotion. Maintenance/calendar ahead of time = proactive.
- Parasympathetic = calming (breathing). Sympathetic = fight or flight.